



P 4 4 · 3 0 P A G E S , P R I N T A B L E , R O A D T R I P S + F L I G H T S

A Toddler Travel Activity Pack

A thirty-page activity pack for road trips and flights with toddlers roughly two to five. Pre-trip prep checklist, the day-of prep, what to pack in the activity bag, eight scavenger hunts (car + flight), four I Spy templates, conversation starters, story-starter prompts, sing-along lyrics for five traditional songs, drawing prompts, a sticker chart, the "if they are losing it" emergency-soothe page, and a trip-memories page to fill in after.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

Travel with a toddler is a managed expectation.

You will not get the four hours of audiobook you used to get. You will not look out the window peacefully. You will spend the trip ten percent in your own head, ninety percent in whatever the kid is doing right now.

This pack is the printable bag of tricks. Scavenger hunts. I Spy. Conversation starters. Story prompts. Sing-along lyrics. A sticker chart. The “if they’re losing it” page.

The pack is not magic. It will not turn a hard trip into an easy one. What it will do is give you ten minutes back at hour three, when you have run out of every other idea.

Soothemade

This is a planning tool. For any travel-related medical questions, including motion sickness, ear pain on flights, or feeding considerations, please follow your pediatric provider’s guidance. The pack does not name medications.

How to use this pack

- Print the whole pack. Pages are 8.5×11, easy to fold into a small envelope or folder.
- Bring colored markers or crayons in a separate small bag.
- Don't pull out everything at once. Rotate. One scavenger hunt, then a snack, then I Spy, then a song. Each thing buys you 10 to 20 minutes.
- The sticker chart goes in last, after the kid is fading. Stickers are a strong currency.

What to pack in the activity bag

THE ACTIVITY BAG (separate from the snack bag, separate from the diaper bag)

- ☐ This packet, printed
- ☐ A small zip pouch with crayons or markers (5 to 8 colors, not more)
- ☐ A pack of regular stickers (not the chart, real stickers)
- ☐ A book or two (small format)
- ☐ A small surprise toy they have not seen (wrapped, for the bottom of hour three)
- ☐ Comfort object (blanket, stuffed animal, the small one they like)
- ☐ Headphones if they tolerate them (for flights especially)
- ☐ A small mirror (toddlers love mirrors)
- ☐ A roll of masking tape (sticky on hands, peel off, sticky on hands, loops of tape, surprisingly long entertainment)
- ☐ A spare set of clothes (one for kid, one for you because they will spill on you)

THE SNACK BAG (separate)

- ☐ One drink (water in a sippy + an extra)
- ☐ Three different types of snacks
- ☐ One special snack (not their usual)
- ☐ A towel or two
- ☐ Wet wipes

THE DIAPER / BATHROOM BAG (separate)

- ☐ Diapers + wipes + change pad (or pull-ups)
- ☐ Empty plastic bag for the inevitable wet outfit
- ☐ Two changes of clothes (one is not enough)
- ☐ Hand sanitizer

A REMINDER: HAVE THE ACTIVITY BAG WITHIN REACH OF THE BACKSEAT.
NOT IN THE TRUNK. ARM'S REACH.

Pre-trip prep checklist

ONE WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ Confirm car-seat installation, especially for long drives
- ☐ Buy or borrow any travel-specific gear (car-seat travel bag, lightweight stroller if flying, packable booster)
- ☐ Pack the activity bag (do not save this for the morning of)
- ☐ Charge any electronics
- ☐ Buy the snacks
- ☐ Buy the surprise wrapped toy
- ☐ Print this pack

THREE DAYS BEFORE

- ☐ Wash anything specific that needs to come (specific stuffed animal, specific blanket)
- ☐ Refill any prescription medications (call your provider for any specific guidance about traveling, ear pain on flights, motion sickness, etc.)
- ☐ Confirm where you are sleeping at the destination

THE NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Pack the snack bag (refrigerated items will go in tomorrow morning)
- ☐ Lay out the activity bag where you can grab it
- ☐ Lay out clothes for everyone for the morning
- ☐ Phone fully charged
- ☐ Reasonable bedtime for the kid (do not let them stay up "to be tired for the trip", overtired kids are harder, not easier)

Day-of prep

MORNING OF

- ☐ Normal-ish breakfast (do not switch this morning)
- ☐ Bathroom right before leaving (and again before getting in the car / onto the plane)
- ☐ Comfortable clothes (no scratchy, no new-shoes-first-time)
- ☐ Get the kid into the car / onto the plane awake if you can, so they can fall asleep there naturally rather than being transferred asleep (which often wakes them up)

FOR FLIGHTS SPECIFICALLY

- ☐ Give yourself extra time at security (toddler shoes off, water and food declared, stroller through scanner)
- ☐ Let them walk in the airport before boarding (the gate-area walk burns energy)
- ☐ Bring something to chew / drink / pacifier for takeoff and landing (helps with ear pressure)
- ☐ Pre-board if they offer family pre-boarding (less crowded)

FOR ROAD TRIPS SPECIFICALLY

- ☐ Plan rest stops every 1.5 to 2 hours, not "when we need to"
- ☐ Bring a towel and a yoga mat or blanket for impromptu nap spots
- ☐ Bring extra napkins, more than you think
- ☐ Have one parent ride in the back periodically if there are two of you

Car-trip scavenger hunt #1

Find as many as you can. Cross off as you go.

- ☐ A red car
- ☐ A blue truck
- ☐ A bridge
- ☐ A river or pond
- ☐ A cow
- ☐ A tractor
- ☐ A barn (any color)
- ☐ A windmill
- ☐ A bird flying
- ☐ A bus
- ☐ A motorcycle
- ☐ A sign with the number 7 on it
- ☐ A flag
- ☐ A horse
- ☐ A construction site
- ☐ A police car (rare but worth a point)
- ☐ A black-and-white animal
- ☐ A train
- ☐ Someone wearing a hat
- ☐ Someone with a beard

POINTS: ____ / 20

PRIZE FOR 10 OR MORE: _____

Car-trip scavenger hunt #2

- ☐ A car with a roof rack
- ☐ A pickup truck
- ☐ A van (any color)
- ☐ A school bus
- ☐ A bicycle on a car
- ☐ A car with a dog inside
- ☐ A car with someone waving
- ☐ An RV or camper
- ☐ A tow truck
- ☐ A semi-truck
- ☐ A car with a license plate from a different state
- ☐ A car with a license plate that has the letter A in it
- ☐ A car with a kid in the back
- ☐ A car with a baby on board sign
- ☐ A car the same color as ours
- ☐ A car the same color as your shirt
- ☐ A car older than mom or dad
- ☐ A car newer than your birthday
- ☐ A roof rack with stuff on it
- ☐ A bumper sticker

POINTS: ____ / 20

Car-trip scavenger hunt #3

- ☐ A diner
- ☐ A gas station
- ☐ A grocery store
- ☐ A fast-food restaurant
- ☐ A car wash
- ☐ A traffic light, red
- ☐ A traffic light, green
- ☐ A traffic light, yellow
- ☐ A stop sign
- ☐ A yield sign
- ☐ A speed limit sign
- ☐ An exit number
- ☐ A mileage sign with the next city
- ☐ A billboard
- ☐ A toll booth
- ☐ A bridge with railings
- ☐ A tunnel
- ☐ A roundabout
- ☐ A road that curves
- ☐ A parking lot with more than 10 cars

POINTS: ____ / 20

Car-trip scavenger hunt #4

WEATHER + NATURE EDITION

- ☐ A cloud shaped like an animal
- ☐ A cloud that looks like a face
- ☐ The sun behind a cloud
- ☐ Trees that look like Christmas trees (evergreens)
- ☐ Trees that have lost their leaves
- ☐ A field of grass
- ☐ A field of corn
- ☐ A field of yellow flowers
- ☐ A river
- ☐ A waterfall (rare, count it as 2)
- ☐ A bird in a tree
- ☐ A bird on a wire
- ☐ A bird flying
- ☐ A puddle on the road
- ☐ A rainbow (count it as 3 if you see one)
- ☐ Sun coming through the trees
- ☐ A mountain
- ☐ A hill
- ☐ A boat
- ☐ A rock that looks like something

POINTS: ____ / 20

SPECIAL FINDS:

Flight / airport scavenger hunt #1

For the airport.

- ☐ A person rolling a suitcase
- ☐ A person carrying a coffee
- ☐ A child crying
- ☐ A child running
- ☐ A child sleeping
- ☐ A person sleeping in a chair
- ☐ A baggage cart with bags piled high
- ☐ A pilot in uniform
- ☐ A flight attendant in uniform
- ☐ A red suitcase
- ☐ A blue suitcase
- ☐ A suitcase with stickers on it
- ☐ A backpack bigger than a person
- ☐ A baby in a stroller
- ☐ A baby in a carrier
- ☐ A person on the phone
- ☐ A person eating at a table
- ☐ A water fountain
- ☐ An escalator
- ☐ A moving walkway

POINTS: ____ / 20

Flight scavenger hunt #2

On the plane.

- ☐ The seatbelt sign turning on
- ☐ The seatbelt sign turning off
- ☐ A flight attendant pushing the cart
- ☐ A small pillow given to you
- ☐ A small blanket given to you
- ☐ The cabin lights dimming
- ☐ The cabin lights brightening
- ☐ A row with all kids
- ☐ A row with one person
- ☐ A row with people sleeping
- ☐ The "fasten seatbelt" announcement
- ☐ A bag of pretzels or peanuts on a cart
- ☐ A drink in a small cup
- ☐ A baby on a different person's lap
- ☐ The view of clouds out the window
- ☐ The view of land out the window
- ☐ A river from the air
- ☐ A road from the air
- ☐ A lake from the air
- ☐ The plane making a turn

POINTS: ____ / 20

Flight scavenger hunt #3

- ☐ A person reading a book
- ☐ A person on a laptop
- ☐ A person on their phone watching something
- ☐ A person eating their own snack
- ☐ A person stretching
- ☐ A pet on a leash (in the airport)
- ☐ A guitar or musical instrument case
- ☐ Someone wearing sunglasses inside
- ☐ Someone wearing a sports jersey
- ☐ A neck pillow being used
- ☐ A person sleeping with a hat on
- ☐ A child watching a tablet
- ☐ A child playing with a toy
- ☐ A coffee cup in a cup holder
- ☐ A water bottle that looks like ours
- ☐ A water bottle that does not look like ours
- ☐ The captain's announcement
- ☐ The "preparing for landing" announcement
- ☐ A bag in an overhead bin you can see from your seat
- ☐ A movie playing on someone's screen

POINTS: ____ / 20

Flight scavenger hunt #4

The window-seat version.

SKY SCAVENGER HUNT

- ☐ A cloud that looks like a sheep
- ☐ A cloud that looks like a fish
- ☐ A cloud that looks like a face
- ☐ A sunset color, pink
- ☐ A sunset color, orange
- ☐ A sunset color, purple
- ☐ Stars (night flights)
- ☐ A different plane in the sky
- ☐ A boat in the water (when over water)
- ☐ A road with cars (small as ants)
- ☐ A field that is a square
- ☐ A round field
- ☐ A river that curves
- ☐ A mountain peak
- ☐ Snow on a mountain
- ☐ Lights in a city at night
- ☐ The wing of the plane
- ☐ A trail behind a different plane
- ☐ The sun on the horizon
- ☐ A pattern made by farms

POINTS: ____ / 20

WHAT I SAW THAT WAS NEW:

I Spy template #1

Fill in what you see. Then guess each other's.

I SPY WITH MY LITTLE EYE...

something _____
that is the color _____

something _____
that you can hold _____

something _____
that is round _____

something _____
that you would eat _____

something _____
that has wheels _____

something _____
that lives outside _____

I Spy template #2

I SPY WITH MY LITTLE EYE...

something fast	_____
something slow	_____
something tall	_____
something short	_____
something old	_____
something new	_____
something soft	_____
something hard	_____

I Spy template #3

I SPY THE COLORS

Red: _____
Orange: _____
Yellow: _____
Green: _____
Blue: _____
Purple: _____
Pink: _____
Brown: _____
Black: _____
White: _____

I Spy template #4

I SPY THE NUMBERS AND LETTERS

Letter A: _____

Letter B: _____

Letter C: _____

Number 1: _____

Number 2: _____

Number 3: _____

Number 4: _____

Number 5: _____

The biggest number you spotted: _____

The most letters on one sign: _____

Conversation starters

For when the kid is bored and the parent is also bored.

EASY ONES

- If our car could fly, where would we go?
- If you could only eat one food forever, what would you pick?
- What is the funniest thing you have ever seen?
- What is the best smell in the world?
- What sound do you like the most?

A LITTLE DEEPER

- What is something you are really good at?
- What was your favorite part of yesterday?
- If our family had a song, what would it be?
- What do you think dogs are saying when they bark?
- What do you think Grandma was like when she was little?

GAMES THAT KEEP GOING

- Twenty questions (kid picks an object, parent guesses with yes/no questions, then switch)
- Would you rather (alternate offering two choices)
- Story chain (each person adds one sentence to a story)
- Rhyme chain (each person says a word that rhymes with the last)
- "What if" (each person poses a hypothetical, the next answers it)

Story-starter prompts

You read the start. They finish (or you go back and forth, one line each).

PROMPT 1

"There was once a very small mouse who lived in a very small house. One day, the mouse heard a sound at the door that the mouse had never heard before. The mouse went to the door and opened it, and..."

PROMPT 2

"In a big city, there was a dog who could understand exactly what humans were saying, but no one knew. Every morning, the dog would walk by a coffee shop and listen to..."

PROMPT 3

"There was a little girl who could turn invisible whenever she put on her grandmother's hat. The first day she discovered this, she..."

PROMPT 4

"A family of bears lived in the forest. The smallest bear could play the piano very well, even though there was no piano in the forest. One day..."

PROMPT 5

"You wake up in the morning and notice your shoes are missing. Not just your shoes. EVERYONE'S shoes in the entire town are gone. You walk to the kitchen and..."

WRITE YOUR OWN PROMPT:

Sing-along lyrics

A few traditional songs the kid (and you) probably half-know.

WHEELS ON THE BUS

The wheels on the bus go round and round,
round and round, round and round.

The wheels on the bus go round and round,
all through the town.

(Then: wipers go swish, horn goes beep, doors go open and shut,
people go up and down, baby goes wah wah wah, mommy goes shh shh shh,
make up your own.)

OLD MACDONALD HAD A FARM

Old MacDonald had a farm, E-I-E-I-O.
And on his farm he had a cow, E-I-E-I-O.
With a moo-moo here and a moo-moo there,
here a moo, there a moo, everywhere a moo-moo.
Old MacDonald had a farm, E-I-E-I-O.

(Repeat with: pig oink, duck quack, sheep baa, horse neigh,
cat meow, dog woof, your kid will pick more.)

TWINKLE TWINKLE LITTLE STAR

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
how I wonder what you are.
Up above the world so high,
like a diamond in the sky.
Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
how I wonder what you are.

THE ITSY BITSY SPIDER

The itsy bitsy spider climbed up the water spout.
Down came the rain and washed the spider out.
Out came the sun and dried up all the rain,
and the itsy bitsy spider climbed up the spout again.

IF YOU'RE HAPPY AND YOU KNOW IT

If you're happy and you know it, clap your hands.

If you're happy and you know it, clap your hands.

If you're happy and you know it, then your face will surely show it.

If you're happy and you know it, clap your hands.

(Repeat with: stomp your feet, shout hooray, do all three.)

Drawing prompt #1

Use crayons or markers. There are no wrong answers.

DRAW WHAT YOU SEE OUT THE WINDOW RIGHT NOW.

(Big blank space below for drawing.)

[illegible]

CAPTION (what is the drawing of):

(They will let you. Or not. Either way, try.)

[illegible]

You have not seen it yet. What do you imagine it looks like?

[illegible]

The sticker chart

You provide the stickers (any small kid stickers will do).

A STICKER GOES IN EACH BOX WHEN THE KID...

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----|
| Used their inside voice | [] |
| Said please or thank you | [] |
| Helped a sibling | [] |
| Tried something new | [] |
| Calmed themselves down | [] |
| Listened the first time | [] |
| Shared something | [] |
| Said something kind | [] |
| Stayed in their seat | [] |
| Used their words | [] |
| Helped pick up | [] |
| Was patient | [] |
| Tried a new food | [] |
| Made someone laugh | [] |
| Said sorry | [] |

WHEN ALL ARE FULL: a small prize at the destination.

PRIZE (decided by parent in advance): _____

If they are losing it

Hour three. Two-year-old is past the activity bag, past the snack, past the song. Crying. Yelling. Saying they want to get out.

THE SOOTHE SEQUENCE

1. Acknowledge.

"I know. This has been a long trip. I'm tired too."

2. Validate the body.

"Your body needs to move."

3. Adjust if possible.

- If in the car: take the next exit, even if it is sooner than planned. Walk around a parking lot for 10 minutes.
- If on the plane: get them out of the seat. Walk up and down the aisle if the seatbelt sign is off. Stand in the back near the bathroom.
- If neither is possible: hold them on your lap. Sing softly. Let them cry. Crying is a release.

4. Reset.

- Offer the wrapped surprise toy.
- Offer a snack.
- Offer to start a fresh activity from the bag.
- Offer to watch something if you have headphones.

5. Survive.

- This will pass.
- You did not cause this.
- The other passengers are not as upset as you think they are.
- The kid will sleep eventually.

A NOTE TO YOURSELF, IN ADVANCE, FOR THE MOMENT YOU ARE EMBARRASSED:

"I am doing the best I can. The people around me have all been here. The ones who have not been here are not the ones whose opinions I care about. The trip will end. The kid will be fine. I will be fine."

Trip memories

To fill in after.

WHERE WE WENT: _____

WHEN: _____

WHO: _____

ONE THING THE KID LOVED:

ONE THING THE KID DID NOT LOVE:

ONE THING THE KID SAID THAT WAS FUNNY:

ONE THING THAT WENT BETTER THAN EXPECTED:

ONE THING I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY NEXT TIME:

THE PICTURE I AM GLAD I TOOK:

THE PICTURE I WISH I HAD TAKEN:

A final note

You traveled with a toddler. That alone is a thing.

You probably did not have the trip you were imagining. You probably had a different trip. The trip that included a meltdown at the airport gate. The trip that included the kid finally sleeping in the back row. The trip that included the moment they pointed out the window at something you had stopped seeing.

The pack carried you for a few of those hours. The rest was you.

You did the thing. You are home.

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Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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